ADITYA ARYA



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The Khyber, Gulmarg

PATNITOP
The Poonch House

A beautifully restored heritage bungalow, the Poonch House will take you approximately three hours to reach from Jammu. Barely three kilometres from the main town, this quaint bed-and-breakfast was built in 1936 by the king of Poonch who wanted to give his queen from Kota a rejuvenating place to stay. Built in stone and wood, the family home has two rooms and a separate cottage for long-term stay. If temples and viewpoints are not up your street, hit some easy nature trails marked around the property, or go for a picnic in the forest nearby. On cold evenings, Poonch House's fireplaces and history together afford warmth and comfort. *(https://bit.ly/3wYzZby; INR 5,500 with breakfast and taxes)*

GULMARG
The Khyber

Easily Kashmir's (and India's) best high-end skiing resort, the Khyber is the ultimate mountain luxury dream. From from the Srinagar airport, this award-winning accommodation even offers enchanting views of the Affarwat peaks, and is an easy walk from the Gulmarg Gondola, the world's highest ski lift. *(khyberhotels.com ; INR 44,000 with breakfast and taxes)*

Highlands Park

This heritage property came up in the 1960s, when Gulmarg had first become an attraction for the travelling Indian. Close to the Gulmarg golf course, the Highlands Park has long been popular with repeat guests who enjoy the boutique nature of its rooms and suites. Atmospheric décor that exudes warmth and class, sweeping views of the Greater Himalayas and some great service all make this family-run hotel a classic. *(highlandspark.in; INR 17,000 with breakfast plus taxes)*

SONMARG
Farah's Homestay

Arriving at Farah's homestay is like walking into a picture postcard. With its idyllic setting—near Sonmarg and on the banks of the Sindh River—this clean and cosy, wallet-friendly, four-room home with open spaces and alpine views demands that you put your feet up for a while. Stop here to unwind, sample homemade Kashmiri food, go fishing, and finally, when you feel up to it, explore Sonmarg (51 km from Srinagar railway station). *(farahshomestay.com; INR 5,000 with breakfast, dinner and taxes)*

GUREZ
Kaka Palace

Gurez, 123 km from Srinagar, draws only the rarest of travellers. But when it does, it is Kaka Palace that offers a clean and safe environment to everyone, from hikers and birders to wildlife researchers and culture enthusiasts. The guesthouse is surrounded by dramatic views, offers Indian food (Kashmiri food on request), and the affable staff help you plan your time and trips in the area. *(kakapalace.business.site; INR 3,500 with breakfast and taxes)*

wellness treatments at its international spa to a heated swimming pool, the resort, at 8,000-plus feet, is pure indulgence. It also has private cottages—perfect for couples or small families—and four eating outlets. Only 65 km away